

Background



Various
Design Tools
Design Purposes
Different Interfaces
for Different Needs



Background

? Are Designers a Specialized Group

After directly participating in design communities, interacting with users, and observing how they communicate, I came to realize that designers may not necessarily constitute a specialized user group. Middle and high school students creating PowerPoint presentations, as well as university students preparing presentations for group projects, may all use design communities. Even if design is not their profession, they can temporarily take on the role of a designer and encounter many of the same concerns and experiences as professional designers.

Users engaging in the experience of a “designer using design software” often need to determine which tools within a particular design program will help them achieve their design goals effectively. In open chat rooms, users typically ask immediate questions to a broad and unspecified audience. In online communities, they tend to post more detailed questions that include specific requirements and context.

! Key Characteristics of Community Conversations

A key characteristic of conversations within these communities is that **their characteristics are difficult to define consistently.**

“Is *Filmora* a good video editing program?”

“I want to convert something rendered in Blender Cycles into an actual mesh, but using a displacement map creates too many triangles. Is there an add-on that can automatically handle retopology?”

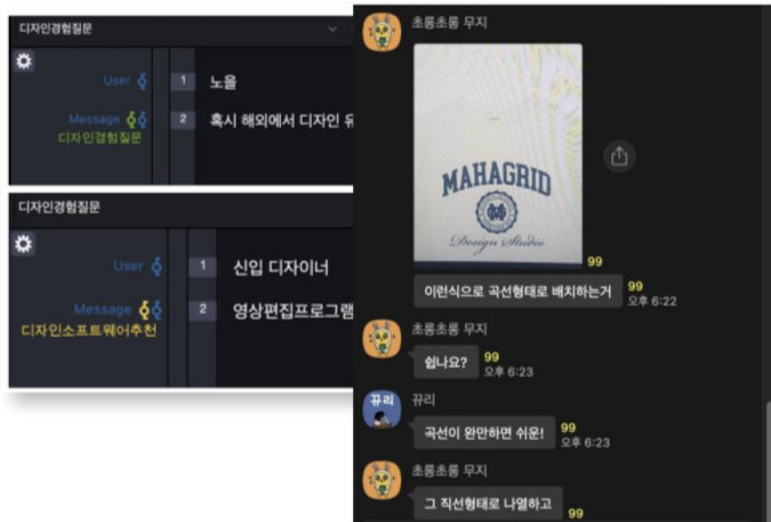
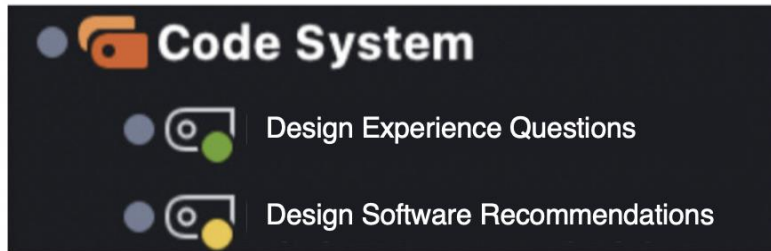
The topics and content of these conversations vary greatly depending on each user’s interests and the software they use. Questions such as those above frequently appear in these communities. As a result, open chat rooms or online communities built around the broad keyword “designer” often bring together people who do not necessarily share the same expertise or interests. In other words, **it is difficult for users to get the answers they need immediately.**

Text Analysis of Online Communities



KakaoTalk open Chat Rooms

- Open Coding



Calculating simple word frequencies related to design did not appear to provide particularly meaningful insights.

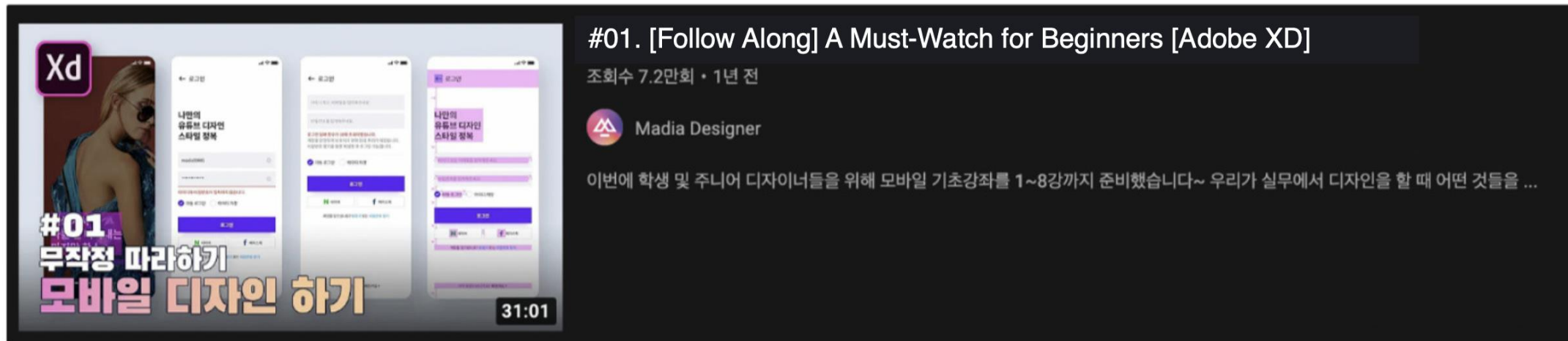
In the KakaoTalk open chat rooms, users raised a wide variety of questions across different fields, including video design, UI design, and product design. Since users with different interests were grouped together under the broad category of “visual design,” it was unsurprising that their interests and questions varied considerably across different areas of design.

I also observed that when users had specific design-related questions, they often had to take a photo or capture a screenshot and upload it before asking their question, adding an extra layer of inconvenience to the process.

Text Analysis of Online Communities

Comments on a YouTube Design Tutorial

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BNPJwgBVZOM>



Comments were collected from a video with approximately 72,000 views.

Using a “follow-along” format, the video explains the tools and features of Adobe XD step by step, allowing viewers to follow the process themselves.

Text Analysis of Online Communities

Comments on a YouTube Design Tutorial

- Open Coding

	1: No.	2: Comment	3: Answer
디자인방법질문 답사댓글	11	006 좋은 강의 정말정말 감사하 보고 있습니다! 질문이 하나 있는데요. 페이지 크기를 처음부터 2배수를 해놓고 디자인을 해 야 하는 이유가 있나요? 내보내기 할 때 배수별 저장할 수 있는 옵션이 있는 것 같은데, 꼭 2배수를 하 시는 이유가 있는지 궁금합니다. 감사합니다!	Park
		006-1 저도 궁금하네용 1배수에선 폰트크기가 어떻게달라지는지도	가나
디자인방법질문 정리댓글	13	006-2 마디아님이 라이브 방송에서 말씀하신 것들을 제 나름대로 정리해서 알려드리 겠습니다. 1. 2배수가 큼지막하게 보기 편해서 2. 배수별 저장 등 자잘한 작업들이 귀찮아서	ym
디자인방법질문 답사댓글	14	006-3 저도 이거 궁금해요! 1) 왜 처음에 2배수로 하는지, 2배수로 한다는게 무슨 말인지..! 2) 2배수로 디자인할 땐 왜 숫자를 짝수로 맞춰야 하는지 넘분 좋은영상 감사합니다 마디아님~	n e
디자인방법질문 답사댓글	15	007 너무 좋은 영상	김상
		008 마디아님 정말 좋은 영상 감사합니다. 아직 학생이고 XD를 미리 배워보고싶 어서 보다가 궁금한 점이 생겨 조심스럽게 질문 하나 드릴라고합니다! 13분 08초에 박스와 텍스트간 좌우 간격은 24로 동일한데 상하 간격은 32와 30으 로 맞지 않는 것으로 보이는데 이 부분은 실무에서도 겹침은 부분인가여? 아 니면 짝수를 맞추기 위해 상하 간격을 31과 31로 맞추지 않으신 건가요! 궁금 합니다! 항상 좋은 영상 감사합니다 😊	정만

Given the nature of YouTube as a video-based community, I were able to read and categorize individual comments.

Some comments could be classified as “Appreciation,” “Summary,” or “Feedback,” while many others fell into categories such as “Design Method Questions,” “Design Experience Questions,” “Software-Related Questions,” and “Design Software Recommendations.”

- Word Cloud



Because the YouTube video was a tutorial focused on a specific software application, the scope of the questions was narrowed to that particular software and its features.

Keywords such as “mouse” and “me too” also stood out in the word cloud.

Users could also refer to specific timestamps in the video when asking questions, making communication between the video creator (instructor) and viewers more convenient and context-specific.

Text Analysis of Online Communities

Comments on a YouTube Design Tutorial

- Axial Coding

I grouped “Feedback,” “Summary Comments,” and “Appreciation Comments” under “Other Comments.”

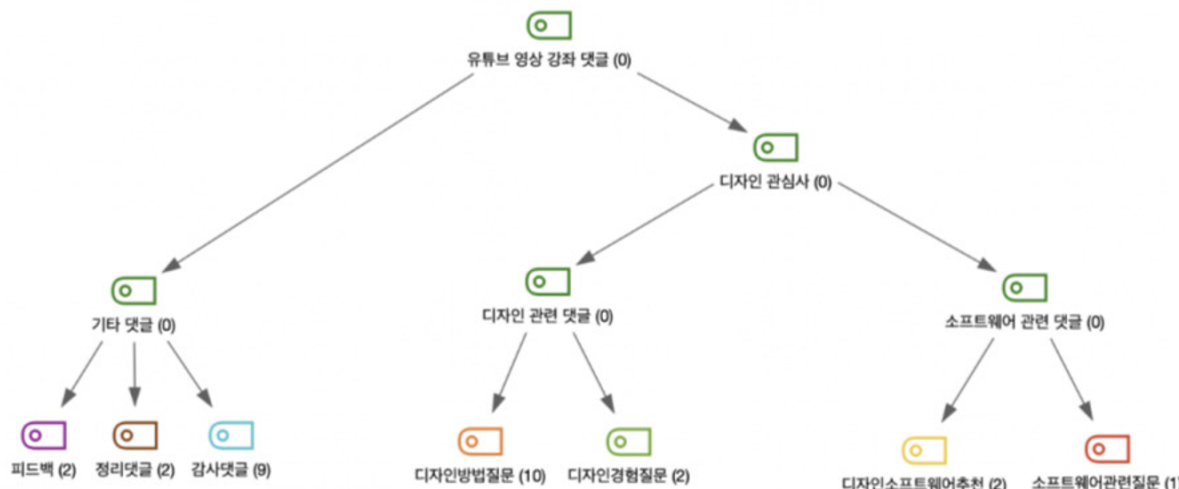
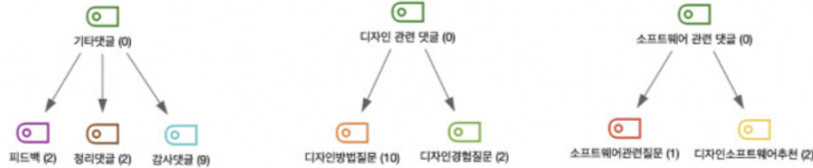
“Design Method Questions” and “Design Experience Questions” were grouped under “Design-Related Comments,” while “Software-Related Questions” and “Design Software Recommendations” were grouped under “Software-Related Comments.”

- Selective Coding

I then conducted selective coding by identifying relationships among the categories.

Comments on the YouTube design tutorial could broadly be divided into two categories: Design-Interest Comments and Other Comments.

Since the selected YouTube video focused on a specific design tool, Adobe XD, there were relatively more design-related comments asking about specific ways to use the tools and features demonstrated in the tutorial than general software-related comments.



Text Analysis of Online Communities



KakaoTalk open Chat Rooms

In the KakaoTalk Open Chat Room, approximately 1,000 users interested in the broad category of “design” gathered to discuss their respective areas of interest.

Because the conversations were spread across many different design fields, the corpus was highly fragmented. As a result, the word cloud did not reveal particularly meaningful patterns, and it was difficult to code the conversations into specific design subfields.



Comments on a YouTube Design Tutorial

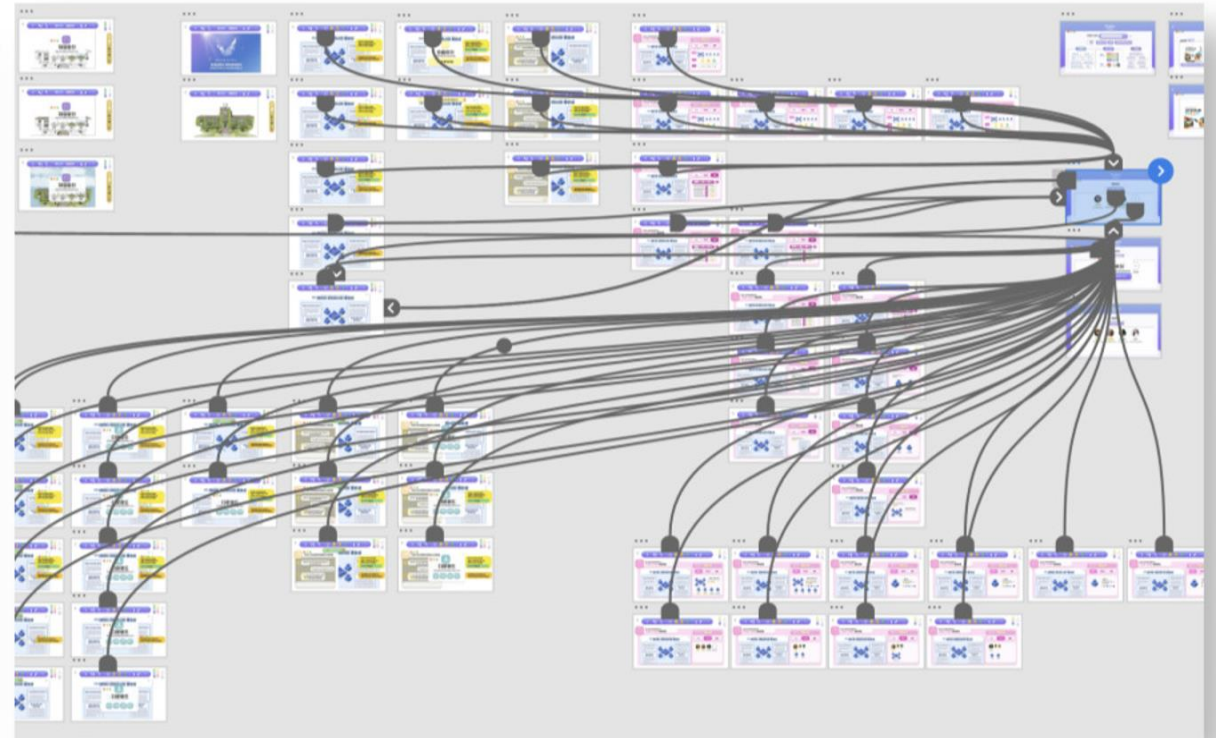
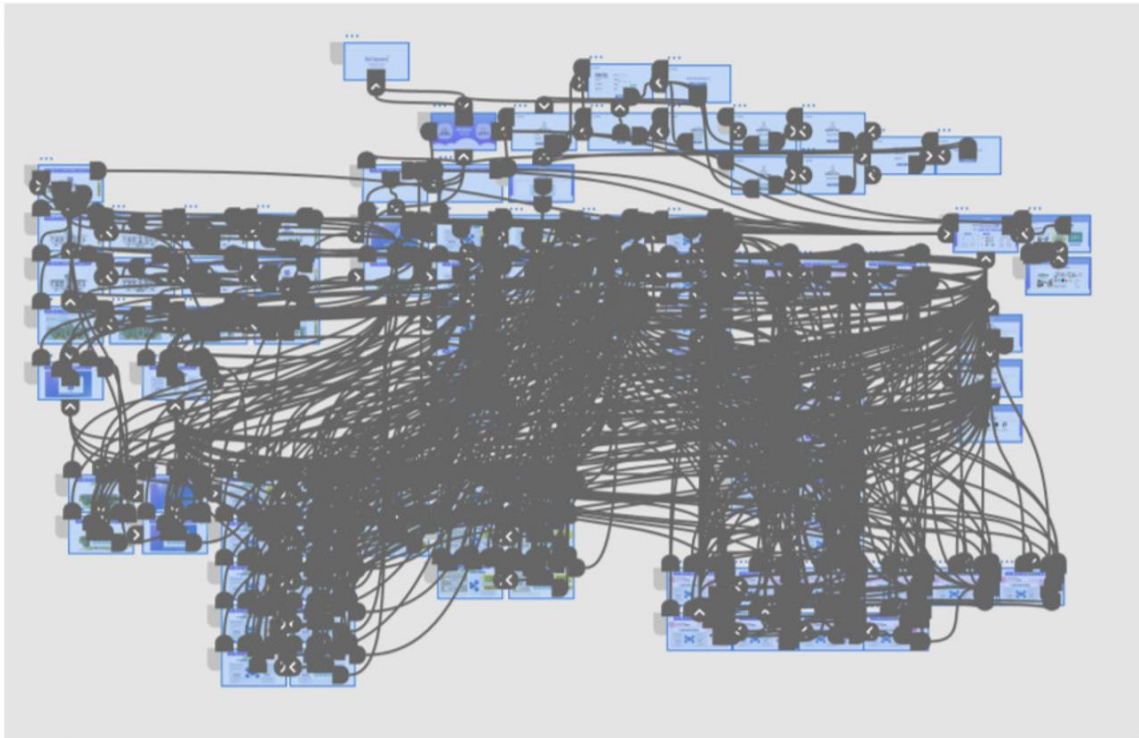
In contrast, the YouTube design tutorial focused on clearly defined topics—Adobe XD and mobile design—allowing viewers with shared and specific interests to communicate through the comments.

A closer examination of the coding results from the YouTube comments revealed a high frequency of keywords such as “mouse” and “cursor.”

After analyzing multiple comments containing these keywords, we identified a recurring issue: viewers needed to follow the instructor’s actions on screen, but the mouse cursor was difficult to see clearly. This appeared to be a common usability problem experienced by multiple viewers.

Prototype

<https://xd.adobe.com/view/aac01d5c-ed77-4bf1-bec0-046e12d599fc-ff93/?fullscreen>



Individual Workspace

Individual & Collaboration Modes

Users can switch between Individual Mode and Collaboration Mode from the top toolbar.

Mouse Mode

This is the default mode, allowing users to perform mouse-based design tasks such as drawing shapes and inserting text.

Pencil Mode

This mode allows users to work with a connected drawing tablet, digital pen, or other pen-based input device.

Since the efficiency of mouse and tablet input can vary depending on the design task, users can switch between input modes according to their needs.

Unlike Mouse Mode, Pencil Mode displays a convenient color palette alongside the workspace.



Group Workspace

Team Management

Clicking this button opens the Team Management page, where users can view detailed information about team members participating in the project and add or remove members.

View Team Members

Users can see who is collaborating on the same project and identify which team members are currently active in the shared workspace in real time.

Feedback

Users can see who is collaborating on the same project and identify which team members are currently active in the shared workspace in real time.

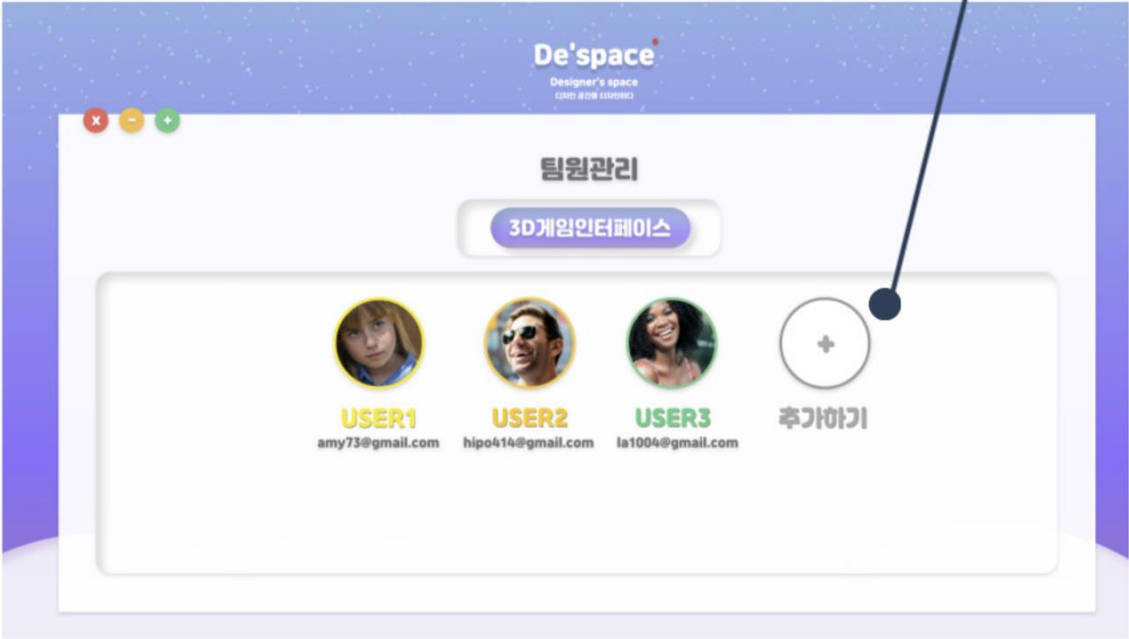
Users can close or hide feedback panels and reply directly to individual feedback messages.



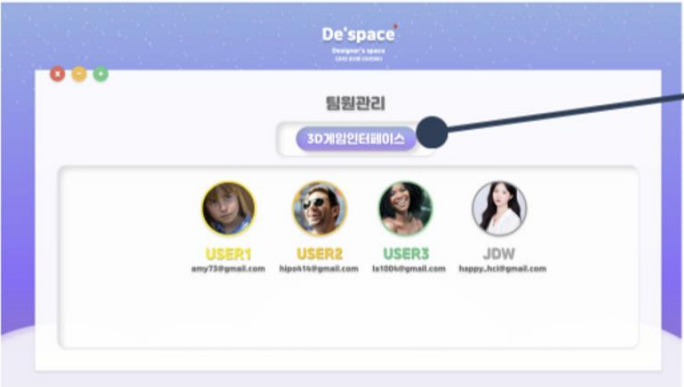
Team Management

Add Member

Team members can be added by entering their email addresses.



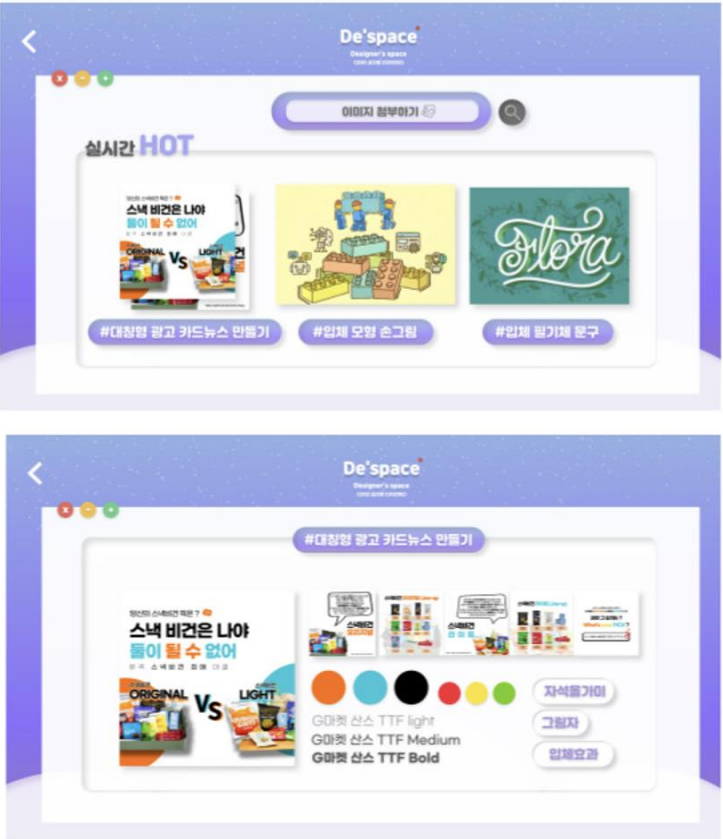
Clicking the “Add” button opens an “Add Team Member” pop-up window.



Users can view detailed information about the team members participating in the design project, including their email addresses.

Search & Share

- Users can search for and share design methods and examples by design type, visual style, or function.
- The image search feature allows users to search for visual references based on elements such as colors or functions. Similar works uploaded by other users are displayed as references for further exploration.



Features by Interface

Primary Icon GUI

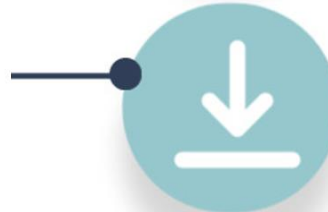
Save

Save design projects to the web platform's cloud storage.



Download

Download design projects in various formats, including PDF, PNG, JPG, and PPT.



Workspace Management

Save multiple versions of design projects and manage workspace storage.



Broadcast

Broadcast announcements to all team members in the design space by displaying a message directly within their workspaces.



Communication

This feature enables users to exchange feedback and collaborate without having to switch back and forth between the design workspace and external messaging applications.



Timeline

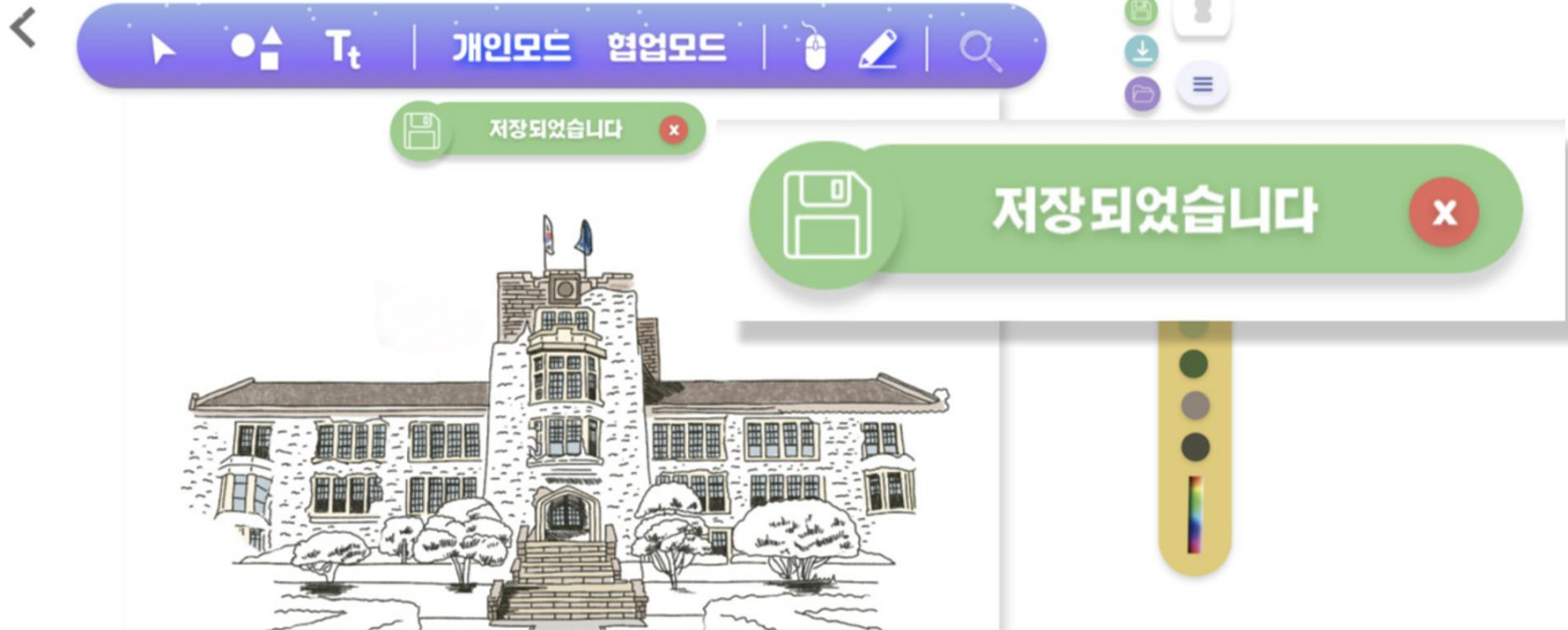
This feature enables users to exchange feedback and collaborate without having to switch back and forth between the design workspace and external messaging applications.



Features by Interface

Save

Design projects can be saved to cloud storage within the web platform.



Features by Interface



Download

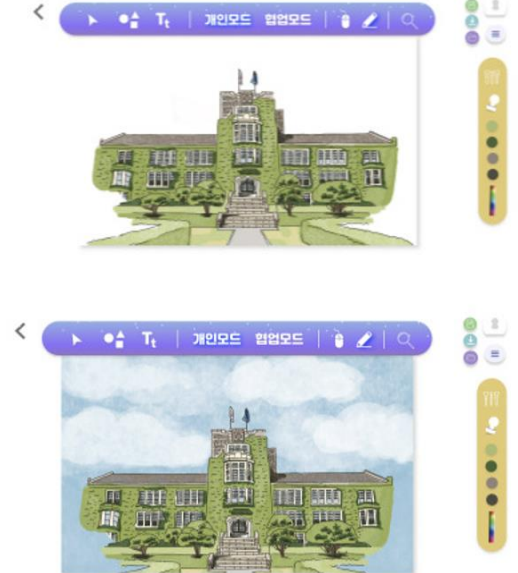
Design projects can be downloaded in various formats, including PDF, PNG, JPG, and PPT.



Features by Interface

Workspace Management

Users can save multiple versions of their design projects and manage their storage space.



Features by Interface



Broadcast

This feature allows users to display announcements directly in the workspace when they need to notify all team members in the design space.



Features by Interface



Communication

This feature eliminates the inconvenience of switching back and forth between the design workspace and external messaging apps when exchanging feedback and collaborating with team members.



Features by Interface



Timeline

The timeline allows users to track who created specific design elements, when they were created, and where they were placed.



Date

View the final contributor for each date and the elements modified on that date.



Element(s)

View the contributor(s) and modification date(s) for each element.



Contributor(s)

View the elements modified by each contributor and the dates of their work.